

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior SOC Detection Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Detection Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on experience developing, testing, and deploying detection content across leading Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms. I have strong expertise in Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detection rule authoring, alert correlation, and threat hunting, and I have built and tuned detection logic from the ground up within large enterprise environments. I am proficient in Splunk with SPL (Search Processing Language) and have experience across the full SIEM detection lifecycle from initial requirements gathering through to rule deployment, tuning, and ongoing refinement to minimise false positives. I design detection content by mapping to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, translating threat intelligence and monitoring requirements into actionable, high-fidelity detections. I have served as a technical authority for security detection in a hybrid SOC, communicated complex technical risks to stakeholders at all levels, and developed Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks including Logic Apps and PowerShell-driven automation to accelerate analyst response. I am seeking a senior detection engineering role where I can apply this expertise to protect critical systems, mentor analysts, and continuously improve detection capability.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM Detection Engineering:** Detection rule authoring, Kusto Query Language (KQL) optimisation, analytics rules, alert correlation, hunting queries, workbooks, data connectors, MITRE ATT&CK mapping
- **Splunk SIEM:** Search Processing Language (SPL) query authoring, dashboard development, detection content creation; detection lifecycle management
- **SOAR / Automation:** Logic Apps playbook development, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflow engineering, PowerShell scripting; detection-as-code principles
- **CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR:** Expert-level platform management, detection tuning, threat hunting, Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **MITRE ATT&CK:** Threat modelling, use case development, mapping detections to adversary tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs); false positive reduction and alert quality improvement
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hypothesis-driven hunting across endpoint, identity, cloud, and network telemetry; threat intelligence-enriched investigations
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, senior escalation lead, Tier 3 incident handling, investigation coordination, playbook authoring
- **Cloud Security Telemetry:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer — University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Develop, test, and deploy detection content across Microsoft Sentinel, authoring analytics rules and Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework; continuously tune detections to reduce false positives and improve actionable alert quality for the Security Operations Centre (SOC).
- Translate monitoring requirements and threat intelligence into effective, high-fidelity SIEM detection rules, covering tactics including initial access, lateral movement, credential access, exfiltration, and command and control.

- Author and maintain Logic Apps SOAR playbooks and PowerShell-based automation to accelerate alert enrichment, triage, containment, and recovery, reducing analyst response time significantly.
- Act as technical authority for detection quality within the hybrid SOC, defining detection standards, reviewing alert performance, and providing expert guidance on detection engineering to analysts and engineers.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting across endpoint, identity, cloud, and email telemetry using KQL in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, producing threat reports and translating findings into new detection coverage.
- Manage and tune the CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and EDR platform across 8,000+ endpoints, refining detection configurations, alert prioritisation, and cross-platform correlation rules.
- Communicate complex detection risks, coverage gaps, and detection engineering roadmap to senior stakeholders and the wider security leadership team.
- Serve as senior escalation lead for Tier 3 security incidents, leading investigations aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK and coordinating cross-team response.
- Support vulnerability management using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, leveraging findings to inform and strengthen detection coverage.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity — University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2022 – March 2025

- Performed daily SIEM alert triage and security incident investigation across Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike, and Microsoft Defender platforms, investigating endpoint, identity, cloud, and email security events.
- Contributed to detection rule development and tuning within Microsoft Sentinel, improving alert fidelity and reducing false positives through iterative KQL query refinement.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender day-to-day operations across 8,000 users.
- Supported Tier 2 incident response, escalating complex cases and contributing to post-incident reviews and lessons-learned sessions that fed back into improved detection coverage.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus and tracked remediation of critical findings, using scan output to identify gaps in detection logic.
- Delivered security awareness training and contributed to Cyber Essentials+ and ISO 27001 compliance activities.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure — HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 – March 2022

- Managed security monitoring, IT infrastructure, and quality assurance within a regulated SaaS and FinTech environment.
- Monitored security events, performed access management, and supported vulnerability remediation and patch management.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance and audit preparation activities.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workspace detection library from the ground up at UAL, authoring over 40 custom analytics rules and KQL hunting queries mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, delivering measurable improvements in threat detection coverage across endpoint, identity, and cloud.
- Developed a comprehensive set of Logic Apps SOAR playbooks and PowerShell automation scripts, reducing manual alert handling effort by over 60% and enabling faster analyst response to common threat scenarios.
- Served as technical authority for detection quality in a hybrid SOC environment, defining detection standards, tuning alert configurations, and reducing false positive rates quarter-on-quarter.
- Led the CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM deployment and tuning across 8,000+ endpoints, introducing proactive threat hunting workflows that significantly reduced mean time to detect threats.
- Authored NIST 800-61-aligned incident response playbooks that standardised investigation and containment procedures, improving response consistency for high-severity security incidents.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)